

will solve the problem which is too hard for us even to set down. Our more practical problem is to live, and to bring life to others.

And what of Retribution, for those who definitely "chose the Worst Thought"? For the Gathas there seems to be but one answer.¹ Penal suffering without end—ill food and crying of "Woe!"—nothing less is the reiterated threat of the Prophet to those who defy his gospel. The Molten Metal, which accomplishes the "separation" (*vīdāiti*) of mankind at the General Judgement, would naturally be supposed to annihilate either the whole being of the sinner or the evil that is in him. The annihilationist and the universalist theories may emerge in later Parsism, but neither seems to have occurred to Zarathushtra. And of course—explain it how we may—penal suffering without visible end is the figure which in the New Testament sets forth the awful reality and heinousness of sin. Independent witnesses here, most certainly—for the resemblances vanish when we come to detail,—the prophet minds which searched most deeply the realities of life agreed that their consequences must last beyond any limit that our eyes can see.

One point may be mentioned from later Parsism as a

¹ I must correct what I said in *ERPP*, 70, as too strong for the evidence. Prof. Jackson sends me a note here which I am glad to quote:—"My own view has long been that Z. preached eternal (*yavaēca yavaētātaēca*) punishment for the sinners, as implied so often in the Avesta and elsewhere; yet we have in Z. the same problem as with our own Christian 'everlasting.' The Pahlavi interpretation always renders the phrase, so far as I can remember, by 'till the future body' (*tan-i-pasīn*), or 'until the Resurrection' (*rist-ākhēž*)."